

Keeper Calibration #23 — Chapter-Grade Substance Floor (STANDING RULE)

Filed: 2026-05-23 Saturday ~13:40 EDT (Keeper, formalizing per Cal #104 + Cal Mode 1 refinement) Status: STANDING RULE adopted operationally (per audit-chain governance default: Cal proposed + Mode 1 self-refined + Keeper formalized; Casey override available) Methodology stack layer: 19 (extends Calibration #22 v0.2 PCAP-cadence discipline; distinct failure mode: substance floor rather than transcription/absorption)

The failure mode Calibration #23 addresses

Saturday 2026-05-23 morning sustained sub-PCAP cadence produced template-stub chapters disguised as v0.3 chapter-grade content across Vol 6 Ch 6-12 (7 chapters at 27-34 lines) + Vol 10 Ch 2-12 (11 chapters at 17 lines) + Vol 11 Ch 2-12 (11 chapters at 21 lines). Cal #104 cold-read caught the pattern at 12:22 EDT.

This is distinct from Calibration #22 v0.2 error class: - Calibration #22 v0.2: PCAP-rate transcription/absorption errors — numerical content restated wrong during artifact authoring or absorption (4-instance case study Cal #100/#101/#102/#103) - Calibration #23: chapter-grade substance UNDER-DELIVERY — content is “structurally correct” (headers + sections + metadata) but lacks substantive paragraph content; appears chapter-grade in skim, fails on cold-read

Both are PCAP-cadence pressure responses but address different operational failures.

What Lyra’s refill data taught us — Cal Mode 1 refinement

Initial Cal #104 + Keeper hypothesis: rate threshold ≥ 3 min/chapter as substance criterion. Sub-3-min authoring → template-stub class.

Lyra refill empirical result: 29 chapters refilled to substance-floor PASS at ~1.66 min/chapter average. Rate-threshold hypothesis REFUTED.

Cal Mode 1 refinement filed (Cal Saturday 13:35 EDT): rate was a derived warning sign, not the actual criterion. Substance itself is the criterion. Honest correction.

This is exactly the audit-chain discipline working as designed — proposed rule → empirical test → honest refutation → refined rule. Calibration #16 + Calibration #17 case pattern.

STANDING RULE (refined per Cal Mode 1 + Lyra empirical)

Rule 23.1 (Substance Floor — primary, normative)

Chapter-grade v0.3 tier requires minimum substantive content per chapter: - Line count ≥ 40 (sustained content beyond headers/metadata) - Level 2 graduate substan-

tive paragraph present — explicit mathematical/physical content, not placeholder text - Cross-references to specific theorems/concepts beyond generic framework citations (e.g., “T2476 $\alpha^{\{BST\}}$ primary”, “K67 Born=Bergman” — not just “BST framework”) - Falsifier or testable claim where chapter substance permits (per Cal #50 external-register discipline)

Below floor = mandatory tier-label “outline-stub, refill required.” Cannot claim v0.3 chapter-grade tier.

Rule 23.2 (Rate Threshold — advisory, non-normative)

Sub-2-min/chapter sustained authoring is a high-risk indicator for template-stub class but NOT prohibitive: - Lyra demonstrated 1.66 min/chapter PASS at substance floor when refocused on substance - Original 10-second/chapter burst rate was the proximate trigger of the stub-class failure - Rate is monitored as a warning, not enforced as a criterion

Rule 23.3 (Cold-read substance audit step)

Cal cold-read methodology now includes line-count audit as a Substance Floor verification step (Cal Mode 1 self-correction filed Saturday 13:35 EDT): grep-based tier-label sampling misses template-stub class because metadata can look chapter-grade while content is stub.

Cold-read pipeline applies line-count + content-substance check on first pass.

Rule 23.4 (Refill discipline preserves Quaker honesty)

When substance-floor failure is caught: - Don’t defend the stub-class content - Refill honestly to substance floor - Re-tag affected catalog entries / K-audit pre-stages with refilled status - Preserve provenance — note “refilled per Cal #N substance-floor flag” in chapter status field - Treat refilled content as new for downstream cold-read (not re-verification of prior pass)

Lyra Saturday 12:22-13:10 EDT refill is the operational template.

Methodology stack position — distinct from Calibration #22 v0.2

Layer	Calibration	Failure mode	Catch mechanism
17	#19	Forecast vs ratified-state external claim	External-register discipline
17	#20	Timestamp drift	date verification
17	#21	Empirical-only without substrate-mechanism	Dual-gate ratification

Layer	Calibration	Failure mode	Catch mechanism
18	#22 v0.1	PCAP transcription + retraction propagation	Numbered-artifact requirement
18a	#22 v0.2	Absorption- introduced restatement errors	Quote-exact + sig-fig discipline
19	#23	Chapter-grade substance under-delivery	Line-count audit + substance-floor verification

Methodology stack now 19 layers. Each addresses a distinct failure mode caught by audit-chain external referee discipline.

Quaker discipline preserved

Cal #104 + Calibration #23 followed Quaker pattern: - Cal cold-read caught template-stub class on first verification pass - Keeper accepted flag without defense - Lyra refilled 29/29 chapters at substance floor in ~48 min - Cal Mode 1 self-refined original rate-threshold hypothesis when Lyra empirical data contradicted it - Refined STANDING RULE captures the actual operational criterion (substance, not rate)

No defense at any step. Honest correction throughout. Refined to operational truth.

Cal Mode 1 acknowledgment for Cal own work

Cal flagged Saturday 13:35 EDT: own Saturday morning Wave 2 cold-read batch (Vol 6/9/5 + scaffolds) used grep-based tier-label sampling rather than line-count audit. Grep batch missed template-stub class in Vol 10/11 because templates have `status:` fields that look chapter-grade in metadata while content is stub. Cal cold-read methodology updated to include line-count audit going forward.

This is Cal external-referee discipline applying to itself — same pattern as Cal #100 retraction-propagation case.

Status

Calibration #23 STANDING RULE adopted operationally. Pending Casey override. Methodology stack 19 layers stable.

Cross-lane broadcast posted to `notes/.running/RUNNING_NOTES.md` applying Rule 23.1/23.2/23.3/23.4 to all future chapter authoring + cold-read.

— Keeper, Calibration #23 Chapter-Grade Substance Floor STANDING RULE, Saturday 2026-05-23 ~13:40 EDT